

Foreword

Successful organisations are built on change. Businesses operate in a real-time environment where the response to changing markets may of necessity be measured in hours and days instead of months and years. In some instances, e.g. financial markets, the response time maybe in seconds. Responsiveness and flexibility are the hallmarks of business success.

The work reported in this special edition of the BT Technology Journal, with the theme of 'The emerging enterprise', demonstrates the vision, breadth and depth of research activities focused on helping BT manage change in strategy, technology and organisation.

It describes the ingredients of an infrastructure to support a highly adaptive, self-organising and dynamic organisation. This infrastructure will provide seamless integration of technology, information and human resource. It will enable flexible process and knowledge management and represents a significant intellectual asset in a growing competitive market space.

Furthermore, for BT to be the market-leading communications enterprise, it has to be faster and more effective at learning, adapting as the world around changes. The ability to model the enterprise, as shown in this issue, could be the basis for managing the evolution of the business.

The Group Technology Programme has funded and supported much of the work that underpins the papers in this issue. We hope the reader gains a valuable insight into how research is facing up to future challenges, enabling BT to become the smart enterprise of the next millennium.

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